reached me on February 26. Fantastic was still looking expensive and beautiful.

In the June 1953 F 6 SF f "Flies" 5 appeared, and a few months later, "Kid Stuff" 6 appeared in the September 1953 Beyond, the second issue of that magazine.

4 See Nightfall and Other Stories.

5 See Nightfall and Other Stories.

e See Earth Is Room Enough (Doubleday, 1957).

*5

David was 1V2 years old on February 20, 1953. He didn't talk much but he understood everything we said and he had a will of his own. When I took him out in order to have him walk under his own steam, it always ended in my having to carry him, for never, under his own steam, would he walk home. Nor, if he sensed that I would find it convenient for him to walk left, would he walk in any other direction but right.

By the time he was nineteen months old, he grew interested in television and learned to manipulate the controls. He was fascinated by the knobs that caused the picture to roll or to tear (or both, for that matter). He quickly learned, however, that this caused alarm and despondency in the breast of his parents, who then removed him from contact with the set. As a result, he sometimes quickly readjusted the set to produce a perfect picture when he heard loud cries of anguish in his rear.

The three of us visited New York on May 21, 1953, in order that I might attend a local New York science-fiction convention the next day. I met Robert Sheckley and A. J. Budrys for the first time on this occasion.

Fred Pohl was more and more closely involved with Ballantine Books at this time. This was a firm that was under the egis of Ian and Betty Ballantine, an extraordinarily attractive, clever, and inventive couple who had great plans indeed. Their intention was to publish books simultaneously in hard- and soft-cover under such conditions that the writer would make far more money than under the older systems.

Fred told me he was going to have all his writers work with Ballantine Books and urged me to agree to do so.